GDD of Trial of Perception: Exclusion

Game's overview: Players experience the game through the concept of "Perception" that will be shown by the game's logic through truth and lies, which actions and consequences don't always happen in the same way.

Game's relevance:

- Player actions are interpreted differently by NPCs based on their perception.

- NPC responses are influenced by trust, uncertainty, and suspicion.

- The game outcome is influenced by how the player is perceived, not just what they do.

Player's Goal: Players must adapt to live in the world of the game by interacting with NPCs and entities, which navigate interactions in a world where perception shapes outcomes rather than reality.

Core mechanic: A narrative-driven psychological simulation game where the same action can lead to different outcomes depending on how it is perceived.

Overall System: Player's action ---> NPC's perception ---> Consequences

For example, helping someone may be seen as kindness or as manipulation, leading to different consequences

System's rule:

- Same action, different outcomes by the law of "Perception".
- NPC evaluates perception, not the whole truth
- Players need to adapt to the "Perception" mechanic of this world.

Core Gameplay Loop:

1. Player actions:
- Engage (Interact with NPC)

- [ ] truth
- [ ] lie

- Ignore (Do not interact)
2. NPC evaluates players based on states (trust/suspicion/uncertainty/caught_count)
3. Perception shifted based on states (Negative/Slightly Negative/Neutral/Slightly Positive/Positive)
4. Outcome changes (dialogues/consequences)
5. Player adapts the next action for Perception [internal state affected by memory] (better/worse)

NPC Systems: The NPC in this game is not just an ordinary NPC that operates in-game, but rather an embodiment of the concept “Perception” and how human perception works, as the same action doesn’t guarantee the same consequences.

Examples:

- NPC A (Neutral): Interprets actions based on what the players do and how the NPC believes.
- NPC B (Slightly Positive): likely to assume positive intent unless strong contradictory evidence.
- NPC C (Positive): Strongly trusts the player, even when actions are contradicted.
- NPC D (Slightly Negative): Questions the player’s intent consequentially.
- NPC E (Negative): likely to assume negative intent by default unless positive evidence.

NPC perception is not fixed, but changes due to evidence, though not always in the same way as expected

The game’s goal: not to perfectly simulate humans, but to explore how humans’ perception shapes interpretation through actions and consequences.

Game Store Description:

Goal: Make players question and spark curiosity about their own perception.

Core message: The same action does not always lead to the same consequences.

“What trial’s result will be?” If you want to know, perceive it via the game’s world as your own trial experiment.